

Acme Corp - Paid Time Off & Leave Policy

Policy ID: ACME-HR-001

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Last Revised: January 1, 2026

Approved By: Sarah Chen, VP of Human Resources

Applies To: All full-time and part-time employees of Acme Corp

1. Purpose

This policy establishes guidelines for paid time off (PTO), sick leave, family and medical leave, parental leave, bereavement leave, and other forms of leave available to Acme Corp employees. The goal is to support work-life balance while ensuring business continuity.

2. Paid Time Off (PTO)

2.1 PTO Accrual Schedule

Acme Corp provides a combined PTO bank that covers vacation and personal days. PTO accrues on a per-pay-period basis (semi-monthly, 24 pay periods per year).

Employment Tenure	Annual PTO Days	Accrual Per Pay Period
0-2 years	15 days (120 hours)	5.0 hours
3-5 years	20 days (160 hours)	6.67 hours
6-10 years	25 days (200 hours)	8.33 hours
11+ years	30 days (240 hours)	10.0 hours

Part-time employees accrue PTO on a prorated basis according to their scheduled weekly hours relative to a 40-hour full-time schedule.

2.2 PTO Carryover

Employees may carry over a maximum of 5 unused PTO days (40 hours) into the following calendar year. Any PTO balance exceeding 5 days on December 31 will be forfeited. Exceptions may be granted by the employee's department head and HR in writing for extraordinary circumstances.

2.3 PTO Request Process

- Employees must submit PTO requests through the Acme HR Portal at least 5 business days in advance for planned absences of 1-3 days.
- Requests for absences of 4 or more consecutive days require at least 15 business days' advance notice.
- Managers must approve or deny PTO requests within 2 business days of submission.
- PTO approval is subject to business needs and team coverage requirements.
- During peak business periods (fiscal quarter-end months: March, June, September, December), PTO requests may be limited and are approved on a first-come, first-served basis.

2.4 PTO Upon Separation

Upon voluntary or involuntary separation from Acme Corp, employees will be paid out for any accrued but unused PTO, up to the maximum carryover balance of 5 days. PTO accrued in the final pay period will be prorated based on days worked.

3. Sick Leave

3.1 Sick Leave Allowance

All full-time employees receive 10 sick days (80 hours) per calendar year. Sick leave is front-loaded on January 1 each year (or on the employee's start date for new hires, prorated for the remainder of the year).

Part-time employees receive sick leave prorated based on their scheduled weekly hours.

3.2 Permitted Uses of Sick Leave

Sick leave may be used for:

- Personal illness, injury, or medical appointments
- Care of an immediate family member (spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent) who is ill or injured
- Mental health days (up to 3 per year without requiring a doctor's note)
- Medical, dental, or vision appointments that cannot be scheduled outside work hours

3.3 Notification Requirements

- Employees must notify their direct manager before the start of their scheduled shift (or as soon as practicable) when taking an unplanned sick day.
 - Notification should be via email or the Acme HR Portal; text messages to your manager are acceptable for same-day absences.
 - For absences of 3 or more consecutive sick days, a doctor's note or medical certification may be required upon

return.

3.4 Sick Leave Carryover and Payout

Unused sick leave does not carry over to the following year and is not paid out upon separation from the company.

4. Family and Medical Leave (FMLA)

4.1 Eligibility

Employees who have worked at Acme Corp for at least 12 months and have logged at least 1,250 hours in the preceding 12-month period are eligible for FMLA leave.

4.2 Leave Entitlement

Eligible employees may take up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave in a 12-month period for the following reasons:

- The birth of a child and to bond with the newborn within one year of birth
- The placement of a child for adoption or foster care and to bond with the newly placed child within one year of placement
- To care for a spouse, child, or parent with a serious health condition
- A serious health condition that makes the employee unable to perform the essential functions of their job
- Any qualifying exigency arising from a spouse, child, or parent being on covered active duty or being notified of an impending call to covered active duty in the Armed Forces

4.3 Military Caregiver Leave

An eligible employee who is the spouse, child, parent, or next of kin of a covered servicemember may take up to 26 weeks of unpaid leave during a single 12-month period to care for the servicemember.

4.4 FMLA Process

1. Employees must provide 30 days' advance notice when the leave is foreseeable.
2. Complete the FMLA Request Form available on the Acme HR Portal.
3. Provide medical certification from a healthcare provider within 15 calendar days of the request.
4. HR will issue a designation notice within 5 business days of receiving sufficient information.

4.5 Benefits During FMLA Leave

- Health insurance coverage continues under the same terms as if the employee were still working.
- The employee is responsible for their share of premium payments during leave.
- Upon return, the employee is restored to the same or an equivalent position with equivalent pay, benefits, and terms of employment.

5. Parental Leave

5.1 Paid Parental Leave

Acme Corp provides 12 weeks of paid parental leave at 100% of the employee's regular base salary for the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child. This benefit is available to all full-time employees who have completed at least 6 months of continuous employment at Acme Corp.

5.2 Eligibility and Timing

- Parental leave must commence within 12 months of the birth, adoption, or foster placement event.
- Leave may be taken consecutively or, with manager approval, intermittently in increments of no less than one week.
- Both parents are eligible for the full 12 weeks if both are employed by Acme Corp.

5.3 Coordination with Other Leave

Paid parental leave runs concurrently with FMLA leave where applicable. If an employee exhausts their 12 weeks of paid parental leave and is eligible for additional FMLA leave, the remaining FMLA leave will be unpaid.

6. Bereavement Leave

6.1 Immediate Family

Employees are granted up to 5 consecutive business days of paid bereavement leave following the death of an immediate family member. Immediate family is defined as: spouse, domestic partner, child (including stepchild), parent (including stepparent), sibling, grandparent, grandchild, or parent-in-law.

6.2 Extended Family

Employees are granted up to 3 consecutive business days of paid bereavement leave following the death of an extended family member: aunt, uncle, niece, nephew, cousin, brother-in-law, or sister-in-law.

6.3 Additional Time

If additional time is needed beyond the bereavement leave period, employees may use PTO or request unpaid leave with manager approval.

7. Jury Duty and Civic Leave

7.1 Jury Duty

Acme Corp provides full pay for the duration of jury duty service. Employees must provide a copy of the jury duty summons to their manager and HR as soon as it is received. If dismissed early on any day of service, the employee is expected to return to work if more than 4 hours remain in the workday.

7.2 Voting Leave

Employees are encouraged to vote during non-working hours. If an employee's work schedule does not permit sufficient time to vote, up to 2 hours of paid leave will be provided on Election Day.

8. Military Leave

Acme Corp complies with the Uniformed Services Employment and Reemployment Rights Act (USERRA). Employees who are members of the uniformed services will be granted leave for military duty as required by law. Acme Corp will pay the difference between military pay and the employee's regular base salary for up to 30 calendar days per year of military leave.

9. Unpaid Leave of Absence

In special circumstances, employees may request an unpaid leave of absence for personal reasons not covered by other leave policies. Such requests require:

- A written request submitted to HR at least 30 days in advance
- Approval by the employee's department head and the VP of Human Resources

- A maximum duration of 90 calendar days
- During unpaid leave, benefits may be continued at the employee's full expense

10. Holiday Interaction

PTO and sick leave cannot be used on designated company holidays (see Acme Corp Holiday Schedule, Policy ACME-HR-006). If a company holiday falls during an employee's approved PTO period, that holiday does not count against the employee's PTO balance.

11. Policy Compliance and Questions

Abuse of leave policies may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination. Employees with questions about this policy should contact the HR department at hr@acmecorp.com or extension x4500.

This policy is subject to change at the discretion of Acme Corp management. Employees will be notified of material changes via email and the Acme HR Portal.